Citation Chasing Example

Excerpt from "What Lies Beneath," Andrew Curry, *The Atlantic*, Oct 2017, pp. 52-57.

In 1980, a 29-year-old Finnish geologist named Timo Aikas accepted a huge responsibility: He joined a team in charge of finding a way to permanently store his country's growing stockpile of nuclear waste. […]

When Aikas began working on the project, repositories were already on the drawing boards in the United States, Sweden, Germany, and elsewhere. The Finns figured that other countries would do the early research and development, and Finland could copy their best ideas. Indeed, the plan Aikas and his team settled on was borrowed from Sweden, which sits on the same slab of bedrock Finland does.

Almost 40 years later, Finland is the only country in the world that has a permanent nuclear-waste repository under construction. The projects Aikas has assumed would be completed long before Finland faltered on NIMBY politics. (Around the world, an estimated 250,000 tons of spent nuclear fuel are stored in temporary facilities that are showing their age, and accidents are surprisingly common; several have occurred in U.S. facilities in the past few years alone. Accidents risk exposing people and the environment to radiation, and cleanup costs can run into the billions of dollars.) "Our original strategy—to follow others—has failed," Aikas says. Nevertheless, the facility he spent his career planning, known as Onkalo—which means "cave" or "hiding place" in Finnish—is on the verge of completion. […]

The Finns avoided NIMBY problems that have stalled other projects by garnering consensus from the outset. Nearby communities were granted veto rights during the planning process. Aikas and his team at Posiva, the company in charge of building the facility, spent years organizing town halls, giving tours of mine shafts, and patiently answering questions about the potential risks of direct meteor strike or future ice age.

Aikas retired in 2014. Today, Ismo Aaltonen, another young Finnish geologist, is shepherding Onkalo through the final phases of construction and preparation. […]

Commented [Office1]: Let's say our theme was nuclear power, or 21st century energy, or something, and that this is the starting source to learn about citation chasing.

Commented [Office2]: This date could be important. It sounds like the general time frame when countries started to worry about nuclear waste.

Commented [Office3]: Can we find out more about him? Did he publish anything? Was he part of any big studies? Did he do any interviews?

Commented [Office4]: So around 1980 these countries started planning nuclear waste repositories. One, that phrase—nuclear waste repositories—is probably worth looking up. Two, what did these countries try to do? Who was involved? What happened?

Commented [Office5]: This is specialized term used several times throughout the article. Since it's not defined, the author assumes we know what it is, so it must be important. What does it mean?

Commented [Office6]: How much nuclear waste is there? Can this amount be verified? What else is out there on nuclear waste more generally?

Commented [Office7]: What accidents have happened in the U.S. in the past few years? How are they been dealt with? What other problems do they cause?

Commented [Office8]: What else has been published about this facility? Are there pictures of it, or diagrams of its layout?

Commented [Office9]: So the Finns did something that other countries did not. Can we find out more about these processes and how they worked, and why they don't seem to be working or pursued elsewhere?

Commented [Office10]: What can we find out about Posiva? What other companies are involved in these finds of facilities? How do they make money?

Commented [Office11]: What are the risks associated with these facilities? These two may pose the most serious threats. What have other written about them? How do engineers plan for these?

Commented [Office12]: Can we find out anything about this researcher? Who is he? How did he get this job?